



CANADA

Capital city: Ottawa**Area:** 3,855,081 sq miles
(9,984,670 sq km)**Population:** 31,500,000**Official languages:**
English, French**Major religions:** Christian
83%, other 17%**Government:** Multiparty
democracy**Currency:** Canadian
dollar**Adult literacy rate:** 99%**Life expectancy:** 79 years**People per doctor:** 476**Televisions:** 715 per
1,000 people

CANADA

THE SECOND LARGEST COUNTRY in the world, Canada occupies two-fifths of the North American continent, stretches across five time zones, and is divided into 10 provinces and three territories. It was once inhabited only by native peoples including the Inuit. The French were the first Europeans to settle in Canada, but after years of fighting the British gained control in 1763. Gradually they took over the rest of the country, as pioneers and settlers moved west and north. Today, Canada is an important industrial nation and one of the world's richest countries. Most of its manufacturing is based on the natural resources of wood, metals, and mineral fuels.

THE CHANGING LANDSCAPE

About one-third of Canada lies within the Arctic Circle and can remain frozen for up to nine months of the year. In these cold northern areas, known as the tundra, any vegetation is limited to lichens, grasses, and small shrubs and trees. Farther south, large areas of land are covered by dense coniferous forests known as taiga. Toward the border with the US lie the mixed, temperate forests and the grasslands of the prairies.



Canadian vegetation zones

- Tundra and polar
- Mountain
- Taiga
- Grassland
- Temperate forest



WHERE PEOPLE LIVE

Canada is such a large country, much of it uninhabitable, that on average there are only eight people living in each square mile (three per square kilometer). Around three-quarters of the population lives near the US border, in towns and cities around the shores of the Great Lakes and along the St. Lawrence River. The rest live in fishing villages along the coasts or on farms and villages inland.

PEOPLE OF CANADA

Until quite recently, most Canadians were descendants of British or French settlers. Most of the French, like those at the winter carnival shown here, live in Québec province. Germans and Italians are also large ethnic groups but, recently, increased numbers of people have come from eastern Europe, South America, and Southeast Asia. Native peoples make up less than 3 percent of the population.



OTTAWA

Ottawa, which is named after the native people who used to live in the area, was chosen as Canada's capital city in 1857 by Queen Victoria of Britain. Today, the city boasts many magnificent copper-roofed government buildings, museums, and art galleries, and a park-lined canal that turns into the world's longest skating rink once the winter freeze sets in.



CALGARY STAMPEDE

Every year since 1923, thousands of people have flocked to Calgary for the famous Calgary Stampede. People dress up cowboy style to celebrate the old Wild West and Alberta's origins as a cattle trading center. Attractions include a rodeo, complete with bucking broncos.